

Marketplace Platform – Founder Requirements

Version 1.0

Purpose

This document defines the functional, operational, security and business requirements for the Marketplace Platform.

It explains **what the platform must do**, not how it should be programmed.

The purpose is to ensure that every developer clearly understands the expected functionality and that no important requirement is misunderstood or overlooked.

Priority Labels

● **Mandatory** – Required before public launch.

● **Recommended** – Strongly recommended before scaling.

● **Future Enhancement** – Can be added in later versions.

⚖️ **Country Specific** – Applies only where required by local laws or regulations.

SECTION 1 – PLATFORM OVERVIEW

1.1 Marketplace Model

Priority: ● Mandatory

The platform must operate as a marketplace connecting Guests with Hosts, Companies and Service Providers.

The platform itself acts as the intermediary and does not own or provide the accommodation, experiences or services unless explicitly stated otherwise.

1.2 Listing Categories

Priority: ● Mandatory

The platform must support the following listing categories:

- Accommodation
- Experiences

- Services

Each category must have customised information fields while maintaining a consistent booking experience.

1.3 User Types

Priority: ● Mandatory

The platform must support:

- Guests
- Individual Hosts
- Companies
- Administrators
- Moderators (optional)

A single account must be able to become both Guest and Host without creating multiple accounts.

1.4 Country Availability

Priority: ● Mandatory

The Administrator must be able to choose which countries the platform operates in.

Countries that are not supported must not allow:

- New registrations (if desired)
- Property listings
- Experience listings
- Service listings
- Bookings

This setting must be manageable through the administration panel without requiring software changes.

1.5 Languages

Priority: ● Mandatory

The platform must support multiple languages.

The system should be designed so additional languages can be added without rebuilding the platform.

1.6 Currencies

Priority: ● Mandatory

The platform must support multiple currencies.

Initial currencies should include at minimum:

- Euro (EUR)
- Swedish Krona (SEK)
- Norwegian Krone (NOK)
- Danish Krone (DKK)
- Turkish Lira (TRY)
- Iraqi Dinar (IQD)
- Canadian Dollar (CAD)
- United States Dollar (USD)
- British Pound (GBP)

The Administrator must be able to add additional currencies in the future.

Currency symbols should be displayed where appropriate.

1.7 Time Zones

Priority: ● Mandatory

Bookings, check-in times, check-out times and notifications must always use the local time zone of the property.

1.8 Mobile Applications

Priority: ● Mandatory

The platform must support:

- Website
- iOS Application
- Android Application

The booking experience should remain consistent across all platforms.

SECTION 2 – HOMEPAGE

2.1 Homepage Search

Priority: ● Mandatory

Users must be able to search for:

- Accommodation
- Experiences
- Services

The search should support:

- Destination
 - Dates
 - Number of Guests
 - Children
 - Infants (optional)
 - Pets (optional)
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2.2 Children's Ages

Priority: ● Mandatory

When selecting children, the platform must first display:

Children (0–17 years)

After selecting the number of children, the user must be able to choose the age of each child individually.

2.3 Homepage Map

Priority: ● Mandatory

The homepage must include a clearly visible Map button.

Users must be able to switch between:

- List View
- Map View

The Map must be easy to find and accessible without navigating through several pages.

2.4 Map Search

Priority: ● Mandatory

Users must be able to browse listings directly on the map.

The Map must support:

- Zoom
 - Drag
 - Search by area
 - Search by city
 - Search by country
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2.5 Nearby Search

Priority: ● Mandatory

Users may choose to allow location access.

If permission is granted, the platform should display:

- Nearby accommodation
- Nearby experiences
- Nearby services

Location must only be used after user consent.

Continuous background tracking must not be enabled unless specifically required for a future feature and clearly explained to the user.

2.6 Open App Button

Priority: ● Mandatory

Next to the Log in button there must be an **Open App** button.

If the application is installed it should open directly.

If not installed it should redirect the user to the appropriate App Store or Google Play page.

2.7 Navigation & Capitalisation

Priority: ● Mandatory

The platform must use consistent sentence case.

Examples:

Correct:

- Contact us
- Log in
- Sign up
- About us

Incorrect:

- Contact Us
- Log Out
- Privacy Policy (when used as a menu item unless legally required)

The interface should remain visually consistent throughout the platform.

2.8 Logo

Priority: ● Mandatory

The platform logo must be clearly visible.

Alternative logo versions may be used for:

- Homepage
- Login
- Registration

The branding should remain consistent across all platforms.

SECTION 3 – USER ACCOUNTS

3.1 Registration

Priority: ● Mandatory

Users must be able to register using:

- Email
- Google
- Apple Sign In

If the iOS application offers Google Sign In or any other third-party login provider, Apple Sign In must also be supported to comply with Apple's App Store Review Guidelines unless a documented exception applies.

3.2 Email Verification

Priority: ● Mandatory

All users must verify their email address before gaining full access to the platform.

3.3 Phone Verification

Priority: ● Mandatory

Hosts must verify their phone number before becoming eligible to publish listings.

Guests may be required to verify their phone number before completing bookings if required by platform policy.

3.4 Password Security

Priority: ● Mandatory

Passwords must never be stored in plain text.

Passwords must be securely hashed using modern industry standards.

Administrators must never be able to view user passwords.

3.5 Profile

Priority: ● Mandatory

Users must be able to:

- Upload a profile photo
 - Edit profile information
 - Change password
 - Delete account
 - Update phone number
 - Update email address
 - Select preferred language
 - Select preferred currency
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3.6 User Roles

Priority: ● Mandatory

One account must be capable of acting as:

- Guest
- Host
- Company

Users should not need multiple accounts.

3.7 Logout

Priority: ● Mandatory

The user menu must display:

Log out

Not:

Logout

SECTION 4 – HOST VERIFICATION

4.1 Becoming a Host

Priority: ● Mandatory

Guests must be able to apply to become Hosts.

They must not be allowed to publish any listing until the verification process has been completed.

4.2 Host Verification

Priority: ● Mandatory

Before a Host can publish their first listing they must complete:

- Email verification
- Phone verification
- Government-issued identification
- Acceptance of Host requirements

- Manual approval by an Administrator

The Host must not be able to bypass any verification step.

4.3 Company Verification

Priority: ● Mandatory

Companies must provide:

- Company name
- Company registration number
- VAT/Tax number where applicable
- Registered address
- Contact person

Companies must be manually approved before publishing listings.

4.4 Manual Approval

Priority: ● Mandatory

The Administrator must be able to:

- Approve
- Reject
- Suspend
- Request additional information

before any Host or Company is allowed to publish their first listing.

4.5 Verification Status

Priority: ● Mandatory

Verification status must be visible to Administrators and the account owner.

Possible statuses include:

- Pending
 - Verified
 - Rejected
 - Suspended
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4.6 Identity Documents

Priority: ● Mandatory

Government-issued identity documents must be stored securely.

Sensitive information such as passport numbers and national identity numbers must be encrypted using AES-256 or an equivalent modern encryption standard.

Only authorised Administrators may access these documents.

4.7 Identity Collection for Guests

Priority: ● Mandatory

Guests should not be required to provide passport or national identity information during normal account registration.

Identity information should instead be collected during the booking process when required for legal, contractual or accommodation purposes.

This keeps the registration process simple while ensuring required information is collected before check-in.

SECTION 5 – PROPERTY LISTINGS

5.1 Add Property

Priority: ● Mandatory

Hosts must be able to create property listings only after successful verification.

The platform must support draft listings before publication.

5.2 Property Approval

Priority: ● Mandatory

A Host's first property listing must be manually reviewed and approved by an Administrator before becoming publicly visible.

The Administrator must be able to continue manually approving future listings if desired.

5.3 Required Property Information

Priority: ● Mandatory

Every property listing must include at minimum:

- Property title
 - Description
 - Property type
 - Number of guests
 - Bedrooms
 - Beds
 - Bathrooms
 - Amenities
 - Photos
 - House rules
 - Check-in time
 - Check-out time
 - Pricing
 - Cancellation policy
 - Complete address
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5.4 Full Address

Priority: ● Mandatory

The Host must enter the complete property address.

The complete address must never be publicly visible.

Only the following may view the full address:

- Host
- Administrator
- Guest with a confirmed booking

Public users must only see the approximate location.

5.5 Approximate Map Location

Priority: ● Mandatory

The public map must never display the exact location of the property.

The platform should use an approximate location (map fuzzing) to protect Host privacy.

The map should indicate that the property is located within the displayed area rather than revealing the exact address.

5.6 Exact Coordinates

Priority: ● Mandatory

The exact address and coordinates must be stored securely within the platform.

Exact coordinates must never be exposed through the public website or public APIs before a booking is confirmed.

5.7 Property Photos

Priority: ● Mandatory

Hosts must be able to upload multiple high-quality property photos.

The Administrator should be able to remove inappropriate or misleading photos.

5.8 Amenities

Priority: ● Mandatory

The platform must include a flexible amenities system.

Examples include:

- Wi-Fi
- Parking
- Pool
- Breakfast
- Airport pick-up
- Guided tours
- Air conditioning
- Kitchen
- Washing machine

The Administrator should be able to add new amenities without requiring software changes.
